Chun Hao (Nico) Liao

+1 416-836-5750 | ch.liao9557@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/nico-liao | nicoliao.vercel.app

Education

University of Toronto Toronto, ON

Honours Bachelor of Science in Computer Science *Sep. 2024 – Expected May 2028*

Experience

Accton Technology May 2026 – Aug. 2026

Full-Stack Developer Intern

- Built internal web tools with Django, Django Ninja, and Tailwind CSS for monitoring network devices and reducing manual setup work.
- Created a PySerial interface for USB barcode and QR scanners that handled device detection, serial commands, and IP verification.
- Used Huey and Redis to move long-running device diagnostics to background tasks and cache frequently requested data.
- Connected ESP32 devices to the backend over MQTT to collect live hardware metrics and device status.
- Containerized the web application, background workers, and Redis with Docker to keep development and testing environments consistent across the team.

UTMIST – FixMyElo Oct. 2025 – Sep. 2026

Project Developer

- Working with a 10-person team on an AlphaZero-style chess engine that models move choices at different player Elo levels.
- Processed PGN game archives into board positions and move data, grouping training samples by player rating.
- Trained a policy–value neural network in PyTorch to predict move probabilities and evaluate board positions for use with Monte Carlo Tree Search.

Softstar Entertainment May 2025 – Aug. 2025

Assistant Developer Intern

- Built a turn-based 3D combat prototype in Unreal Engine 5 using C++ and Blueprints, including turn order, character stats, and basic enemy behavior.
- Created combat menus, action prompts, and status displays with Unreal Motion Graphics (UMG).
- Presented demo builds during design meetings and iterated on the combat system and UI based on feedback from the team.

University of Toronto Game Design and Development Club Apr. 2025 – Present

Event Coordinator

- Organized game jams and competitions for 100+ students, coordinating schedules, judging, prizes, and collaboration with other student clubs.
- Reached out to external sponsors and secured prizes for club competitions and events.
- Helped members debug gameplay systems and mechanics in Unity and Godot projects during game jams and club activities.

Awards

USACO Gold Division 2024

International Merit Admission Award 2024

Meta Hacker Cup Certificate 2022 – 2023

Technical Skills

Programming Languages: Python, C++, C#, Java, C, JavaScript, SQL, Bash, HTML/CSS
Frameworks & Libraries: Django, Django Ninja, PyTorch, NumPy, Pandas, Tailwind CSS, PySerial
Databases: PostgreSQL, SQLite, Redis
Developer Tools & Technologies: Git, Docker, Docker Compose, Linux, REST APIs, OpenAPI, MQTT
Game Development & AI: Unreal Engine 5, Unity, Godot, Monte Carlo Tree Search
Spoken Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Fluent)